

Firearms Trace Data: North Carolina - 2023

Data Source: Firearms Tracing System

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Contents

1. [ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer](#)
2. Table: [Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in North Carolina in Calendar Year 2023](#)
3. Table: [Firearm Types with a North Carolina Recovery](#)
4. Table: [Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with a North Carolina Recovery](#)
5. Table: [Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a North Carolina Recovery](#)
6. Table: [Top 15 Source States for Firearms with a North Carolina Recovery](#)
7. Table: [Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with a North Carolina Recovery](#)
8. Table: [Age of Possessors for Firearms with a North Carolina Recovery](#)
9. Table: [Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a North Carolina Recovery](#)
10. [Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics](#)

ATF Firearms Trace Data Disclaimer

Firearm traces are designed to assist law enforcement authorities in conducting investigations by tracking the sale and possession of specific firearms. Law enforcement agencies may request firearms traces for any investigative reason, and those reasons are not necessarily reported to the federal government. Not all firearms used in crime are traced and not all firearms traced are used in crime.

Firearms selected for tracing are not chosen for purposes of determining which types, makes or models of firearms are used for illicit purposes. The firearms selected do not constitute a random sample and should not be considered representative of the larger universe of all firearms used by criminals, or any

subset of that universe. Firearms are normally traced to the first retail seller, and sources reported for firearms traced do not necessarily represent the sources or methods by which firearms in general are acquired for use in crime.

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced in North Carolina in Calendar Year 2023

27,420

Firearm Types with a North Carolina Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Pistols	20,816
Rifles	2,867
Revolvers	1,854
Shotguns	1,547
Machinegun Conversion Devices	128
Derringers	109
Other*	99

* Other includes Machineguns, Receivers/Frames, Unknown Types, Silencers, Combinations, Any Other Weapons and a Flare Gun.

Top Calibers Reported on Firearm Traces with a North Carolina Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

9mm	13,049
.40 Cal	2,564

.22 Cal	1,869
.380 Cal	1,675
.45 Cal	1,448
12GA	1,226
.38 Cal	816
5.56mm	749
7.62mm	574
.357 Cal	428

NOTE: There were 2,765 additional traces that were associated with other calibers. There were 257 traces with an unknown caliber.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a North Carolina Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Possession of Weapon	9,508
Firearm Under Investigation	4,437
Carrying Concealed Weapon	2,954
Found Firearm	2,658
Dangerous Drugs	1,326
Family Offense	929
Weapon Offense	825
Property Crimes	811
Aggravated Assault	749
Homicide	653

NOTE: There were 2,570 additional traces that were associated with other categories.

Top 15 Source States for Firearms with a North Carolina Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

North Carolina	18,080
South Carolina	1,322
Virginia	851
Georgia	517
Florida	371
Texas	225
Tennessee	177
Ohio	157
West Virginia	122
Alabama	117
Kentucky	106
Pennsylvania	104
Mississippi	72
Arizona	68
Indiana	65

NOTE: An additional 34 states, the District of Columbia and Puerto Rico accounted for 781 other traces. The source state was identified in 23,135 total traces.

Time-To-Crime Rates for Firearms with a North Carolina Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Under 3 Months	2,576
3 Months to Under 7 Months	1,993
7 Months to Under 1 Year	1,660
1 Year to Under 2 Years	3,418
2 Years to Under 3 Years	3,103
3 Years and Over	10,180

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 North Carolina Average Time-to-Crime: **5.75 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Time-to-Crime: **6.76 Years**

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a North Carolina Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

17 and Under	879
18 to 21	3,146
22 to 24	2,505
25 to 30	3,794
31 to 40	4,297
41 to 50	2,058
Over 50	2,043

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 North Carolina Average Age of Possessor: **33 Years**

1/1/2023-12/31/2023 National Average Age of Possessor: **35 Years**

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a North Carolina Recovery

January 1, 2023 – December 31, 2023

Charlotte	4,561
Greensboro	1,874
Winston-Salem	1,571
Raleigh	1,481
Durham	924
Greenville	849
Wilmington	720
Statesville	551
High Point	523
Rocky Mount	482

NOTE: There were 517 additional municipalities that accounted for 13,871 other traces. The recovery city could not be determined for 13 traces.

Analytical Criteria Used to Compile the Enclosed Statistics

Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced

- Includes traces with a recovery state of North Carolina. Traces in which the recovery state was not provided were included when the requesting agency state was equal to North Carolina.

- Includes Firearms Recovered and Traced between 1/1/2023 –12/31/2023 or, if the recovery date was blank, firearms with trace entry dates between 1/1/2023 –12/31/2023.
- Duplicate traces, Firearms Not Recovered, Gun Buyback and Firearms Turned In are not included in this figure.
- Data was extracted from the Firearms Tracing System (FTS) on April 10, 2024.
- All traces may not have been submitted or completed at the time of this study.

Firearm Types and Calibers with a North Carolina Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Categories Reported on Firearm Traces with a North Carolina Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.

Top Source States for Firearms with a North Carolina Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser and the state in which the final dealer is located.

Time-to-Crime Rates for Firearms with a North Carolina Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Traces must identify a purchaser.
- Time-to-Crime was calculated for those traces in which the purchase date could be subtracted from the recovery date.

Age of Possessors for Firearms with a North Carolina Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces that provide a possessor and the possessor's date of birth.
- Possessor's age is calculated by subtracting the possessor's date of birth from the recovery date.

Top Recovery Cities for Firearms with a North Carolina Recovery

- Includes same criteria as Total Number of Firearms Recovered and Traced.
- Includes traces with a recovery city or, if the recovery city was not provided, traces requested by agencies with jurisdiction only within that city.

[View All 2023 Firearms Trace Data](#)

Last updated: December 9, 2024